# Mesopotamia & Sumer -- Key Words (Answer key)

Name: _____

**Word bank:** alliance · artisan · city-state · cradle of civilization · cuneiform · epic · Fertile Crescent · hereditary · irrigation · Mesopotamia · monarchy · polytheism · scribe · silt · surplus · ziggurat

Write the word from the word bank that matches each meaning.

1. "the land between the rivers" (Greek); between the Tigris and Euphrates Rivers
   **Mesopotamia**
2. A city and the lands around it, with its own government, not part of a larger state
   **city-state**
3. A curving strip of good farmland from the Mediterranean Sea to the Persian Gulf
   **Fertile Crescent**
4. A government ruled by a king
   **monarchy**
5. A large temple; the name means "to rise high"; the top was the god's home
   **ziggurat**
6. A long poem that tells the story of a hero
   **epic**
7. A name for Mesopotamia: the beginning of organized human society
   **cradle of civilization**
8. A skilled worker who makes things like cloth, pottery, tools, and weapons
   **artisan**
9. An agreement to help each other and protect common interests
   **alliance**
10. An extra amount (of food)
    **surplus**
11. An official record keeper
    **scribe**

12. Passed down in a family: when the king died, his son took over
    **hereditary**

13. Small particles of soil left behind by floods; very good for farming
    **silt**

14. Sumerian writing made of wedge-shaped marks cut into damp clay with a sharp reed
    **cuneiform**

15. Watering crops by digging canals that carry water from a water source to the fields
    **irrigation**

16. Worshipping many gods
    **polytheism**